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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

RULER, PLASTIC, DESK

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a plastic desk ruler with an inch scale and a metric scale.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406 - Plastics; Methods of Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the *Index of Federal Specifications and Standards* and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

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FSC 7510

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Plastic. The rulers shall be of general purpose polystyrene plastic. The plastic shall be clear, colorless, transparent, and shall otherwise meet the quality and performance characteristics specified herein. The plastic shall have a minimum tensile strength of 5,000 p.s.i. when tested as described in 4.4.2. Scrap material will not be permitted.

3.1.2 Marking material. The material used for marking the graduations and figures shall be waterproof, black in color, and of good commercial quality for the purpose (see 3.4 and 3.5).

3.2 Construction. The rulers shall be molded from polystyrene plastic and have square corners in accordance with good commercial practice. The top surface shall be of the two-bevel type. The bottom surface of the ruler shall be undercut along each edge, and for the full length of the ruler. The undercut shall be not less than 1/64 inch in height, and 1/16 inch in depth as measured on the width of the ruler.

3.3 Dimensions and tolerances. Dimensions and tolerances of the rulers shall be as specified in table I. (See 4.4.3.)

Table I. Dimensions and tolerances

Length	Width		Thickness 1/
	Min.	Max.	
Inches	Inches	Inches	Inch
12 + 1/32 - 0	1-1/16	1-3/16	0.150 ± .020

1/ This dimension shall be measured at the point of maximum ruler thickness.

3.3.1 Straightness of working edges. The permissable departure of each working edge of the rulers from a straightedge, measured at points of maximum departure, shall not exceed 1/32 inch.

Note. Permissable departure from a straightedge refers to the distance between two lines parallel to the length of the ruler, one line touching a point on the edge of the ruler at maximum bulge, the other line touching points on the edge where there is a maximum depression.

3.3.2 Flatness. The permissable departure of the bottom surface of the rulers from a straightedge, measured at point of maximum departure, shall not exceed 1/32 inch (see above note).

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3.3.3 Accuracy of graduations. Graduations on both scales shall be accurate to within 1/64 inch. The total accumulated error, for each scale, shall not exceed 1/16 inch.

3.4 Graduations. The graduations shall be located at the outer edges of the beveled top sides of the ruler, and shall be raised to a uniform height of approximately 0.005 inch from the base. Each graduation shall be face-marked in black waterproof material (see 3.1.2). The length of each different graduation marking for each scale, shall be as specified in table II.

Table II. Length of graduation markings

Scale	Graduation	Length
		Inch, minimum
Metric	1 Millimeter	5/64
Metric	5 Millimeters	7/64
Metric	10 Millimeters	11/64
Inch	1/16 inch	1/16
Inch	1/8 inch	5/64
Inch	1/4 inch	7/64
Inch	1/2 inch	9/64
Inch	1 inch	11/64

3.4.1 Inch scale. The inch scale shall contain not less than 191 clearly visible graduations. The ends of the ruler may serve as the graduation marking at each end of the scale.

3.4.2 Metric scale. The metric scale shall contain not less than 301 clearly visible graduations.

3.5 Figures. The figures shall be not less than 3/32 inch in height, and shall be uniformly raised to approximately 0.005 inch from the base. Figures 1 through 12 for the inch scale and 1 through 30 for the metric scale, shall be located adjacent to the appropriate inch graduation and decimeter graduation, respectively, and toward the center of the ruler as measured on the ruler width. Figures, for each scale, shall read from left to right, and shall begin at opposite ends of the ruler. All figures shall be face-marked in black waterproof material (see 3.1.2).

3.6 Identification marking. The manufacturer's name or trademark shall be stamped or otherwise permanently and legibly marked on the ruler.

3.7 Workmanship. All surfaces of the ruler shall be smooth. Rulers shall be free from any defects and imperfections which adversely affect appearance or which might impair serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications and standards.

4.1.1.1 Component testing. Each lot of component material shall be tested in accordance with the applicable test methods specified hereinafter, to determine compliance with the requirements in section 3. Each inspection lot shall consist of a component of a single type, grade, class, size, and composition, manufactured by the same source, under essentially the same conditions and the same time, and properly segregated and identified.

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4.1.1.2 Evidence of compliance. In lieu of utilizing his own facilities, the contractor may submit a report of analysis of the component materials from any other laboratory acceptable to the Government as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The report of analysis shall include in addition to the actual test data, the manufacturer's name, name and location of the testing laboratory, date of test and quantity of material represented by the test report.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all plastic desk rulers offered for inspection at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling for examination. A random sample of rulers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-4. The Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall not exceed 6.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one ruler.

4.2.3 Sampling for tests.

4.2.3.1 Component material (see 4.1.1.1 and 4.1.1.2). Failure to meet the tensile strength requirements of 3.1.1 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.3.2 Rulers. A random sample of rulers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-1. The AQL shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one ruler.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with and AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table III. Any ruler in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. The Government reserves the right to classify as a defect any departure from the specification not listed in table III.

Table III. Classification of ruler defects

Examine	Defects
Materials:	
Plastic	Not clear, colorless, transparent, general purpose polystyrene.
Marking material	Not waterproof and black in color.
Construction:	Not molded from polystyrene plastic. Corners not square. Top surface not of two-bevel type. Bottom surface not undercut as specified.
Graduations:	Not as specified in 3.4.
Inch scale	Not as specified in 3.4.1.
Metric scale	Not as specified in 3.4.2.
Figures:	Not as specified in 3.5.
Identification markings:	Not permanently and legibly marked.
Workmanship:	Not as specified in 3.7.

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4.4 *Test methods.*

4.4.1 Conditioning of test specimens. Test specimens shall be conditioned in an atmosphere maintained at a temperature of 23° ± 1.1°C. (73.5 ± 2°F.) and 50 ± 4 percent relative humidity for 24 hours.

4.4.2 Tensile strength. The tensile strength of plastic material shall be determined by testing five specimens, 0.125 inch thick. The test shall be conducted in accordance with Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406, method 1011, using type type I specimens except that head travel of the tensile testing machine shall be 0.2-inch-per-minute throughout the test.

4.4.3 Dimensions and tolerances. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3.2 shall be tested with a straightedge or scale of recognized accuracy for the requirements of 3.3, 3.3.1, 3.3.2, and 3.3.3.

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV.

Table IV. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	*Omitted; incorrect;* illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. *Distortion* of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	*Number per container is more or less than* required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve rulers shall be packaged in a folding carton or setup box conforming to PPP-B-566 and PPP-B-665, respectively. Box closure shall conform to the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve rulers shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The rulers shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Rulers packaged as specified in 5.1.1 in quantities as specified (see 6.2) shall be packed in overseas-type fiberboard boxes *conforming to class* weather-resistant, grade V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Gross weight of boxes shall not exceed the weight limitation of the box specification. Box closure and strapping shall conform to the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four unit packages of rulers, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a shipping container conforming to class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with appendix to the box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The rulers shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The plastic rulers are intended for general office use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Quantities of unit packages in shipping container (see 5.2.1).

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